

Document 21: Campus Health Services & Medical Emergency Protocols

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1. The Campus Clinic and Free Basic Healthcare

The university wants to make sure every student stays healthy without worrying about daily medical costs. To do this, HIT operates the Sanjeevani Campus Clinic, which is located on the ground floor of the central student center. The clinic is open 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, and is staffed by two full-time general doctors and four registered nurses.

When a student feels sick with common issues like a fever, cold, stomach pain, or minor cuts, they can visit the clinic at any time. The student must show their physical university ID card at the reception desk to get treated.

- **Free Basic Medicines:** The clinic has a pharmacy that gives out basic medicines (like paracetamol for fever, cough syrups, or bandages) completely free of charge for up to three days.
- **Specialist Visits:** The university also invites specialist doctors (like skin doctors, eye doctors, and bone specialists) to visit the campus every Wednesday and Saturday afternoon. Consultations with these specialists are free, but the student must book an appointment on the student portal at least 48 hours in advance. Walk-ins are not allowed for specialists.
- **Leave Limits:** The campus clinic doctors are only allowed to give a maximum of three days of "Sick Leave" for minor illnesses. If a student is sick for more than three days, the campus doctor will direct them to go to a major outside hospital for further testing.

2. Mandatory Student Health Insurance Rules

Every student pays a Comprehensive Student Services Levy at the start of the year. A large portion of this fee is used to buy a premium health insurance policy for the student through the university's partner insurance company. This policy is active from August 1st to July 31st every year.

This health insurance is designed to protect students from massive hospital bills if they suffer a major accident or a serious illness (like dengue fever or a broken leg).

- **The Coverage Limit:** The insurance covers up to ₹2,00,000 (Two Lakh Rupees) per year for hospital bills.
- **The 24-Hour Rule:** To use this insurance, the student must be formally admitted to a hospital bed for a minimum of 24 hours. This is called "in-patient treatment." You cannot use this insurance for simple doctor visits or buying regular medicines from an outside pharmacy.
- **Day-Care Exceptions:** There is an exception for specific treatments that take less than 24 hours, like minor surgeries or receiving stitches. For these "day-care procedures," the insurance will pay a maximum of ₹25,000.
- **Exclusions:** The insurance does not pay for dental work (like fixing cavities), buying eyeglasses or contact lenses, or cosmetic treatments (like acne removal). Students must pay for these out of their own pockets.

3. Medical Emergency and Ambulance Protocols

In the event of a severe emergency, time is very important. An emergency includes situations where a student faints, has trouble breathing, suffers a severe sports injury, or experiences heavy bleeding.

If an emergency happens anywhere on campus, students must not try to drive the injured person to the hospital on a personal motorcycle or in a private car. Moving a badly injured person incorrectly can cause permanent damage. Instead, the student must immediately call the 24/7 Campus Emergency Number (printed on the back of every ID card).

- **Ambulance Dispatch:** The university keeps two fully equipped life-support ambulances parked near the hostel blocks. Once the emergency number is called, the ambulance will reach any location on the campus within 5 minutes.
- **Escort Rules:** When the injured student is placed in the ambulance, exactly one friend or roommate is allowed to ride along as an escort. A campus security guard will also travel in the ambulance to help with hospital admission forms.
- **Cost and Billing:** The university pays the fuel and driver costs for the ambulance trip. However, once the student arrives at the outside hospital, all medical bills are the responsibility of the student and their insurance plan.

4. Mental Health Support and Counseling Privacy

University life can be very stressful due to exams, placement pressures, and being away from home. HIT treats mental health just as seriously as physical health. The university operates a dedicated counseling center called "MindSpace," which is located in a quiet, private area behind the central library.

Students can visit MindSpace to talk to certified professional psychologists about anxiety, depression, relationship issues, or academic stress.

- **Free Sessions:** Every student is allowed up to 8 free, one-hour counseling sessions per semester.
- **Strict Privacy Rule:** The most important rule of the MindSpace center is complete privacy. The counselors will never tell your professors, your hostel warden, or your parents that you are attending counseling. Your mental health visits are not printed on your academic transcript and do not affect your job placements.
- **The Only Exception to Privacy:** The only time a counselor is legally allowed to break this privacy rule is if the student clearly threatens to physically harm themselves or someone else. In this extreme case, the counselor will inform the Chief Medical Officer and the student's parents to keep the student safe.

5. Hazardous Lab Accidents and Safety Fines

Engineering students spend a lot of time working with dangerous chemicals, high-voltage electricity, and heavy cutting machines in the university laboratories. Because of this, safety rules are very strict.

If a student gets hurt in a laboratory—for example, if a chemical spills on their hand or they get cut by a machine—they must immediately wash the area and tell the laboratory teacher.

- **The Incident Report:** Before the student is sent to the campus clinic for a bandage, the laboratory teacher must quickly fill out an "Incident Report." This report explains exactly how the accident happened.
- **Safety Gear Penalty:** The university provides safety goggles, thick gloves, and protective coats in every lab. If the Incident Report shows that the student got hurt because they refused to wear their safety gear, the university will still treat their injuries for free. However, the student will be charged a strict fine of ₹1,000 for breaking safety protocols, and they will be banned from entering that specific lab for two weeks.

6. Fake Medical Certificates and Verification Checks

If a student misses a mid-term exam or falls short of the 75% attendance rule because they were sick, they must submit a medical certificate from a recognized hospital to request a pardon.

Because some students try to buy fake medical certificates from local pharmacies just to skip exams, the university has created a very strict verification system.

- **The Verification Call:** When a student submits a medical certificate to their department, the document is sent to the Chief Medical Officer at the campus clinic. The campus doctor will call the outside hospital or clinic listed on the paper to confirm that the student was actually treated there on those specific dates.
- **Punishment for Forgery:** If the outside hospital says they have no record of the student, or if the doctor's signature is proven to be fake, the consequences are severe. The student will instantly fail the subject they tried to skip. Furthermore, submitting forged documents is considered a major disciplinary crime, and the student will be suspended from the university for one entire 6-month semester.